FREE RESOURCE · AI & FINANCE AUTOMATION

Finance Automation Readiness Assessment

A 20-question self-assessment covering data quality, process maturity, technical readiness, skills and capacity, and governance. Score your readiness before selecting a vendor.

20 Questions | 5 Dimensions | Scoring Guide | Free Download

20 questions	**5** dimensions	**Scoring** guide	**Actionable**

Data Quality

- [ ] **Our financial master data (chart of accounts, cost centres, supplier master) is clean and consistently maintained**
  Clean master data is the single most important prerequisite for automation. Most implementations that fail or underdeliver do so because of data quality issues discovered too late.
- [ ] **Transaction data is consistently coded to the correct GL account and cost centre**
  Inconsistent coding means automation cannot reliably classify transactions — the exception rate will be too high to deliver ROI.
- [ ] **We have a documented data governance process with named owners**
  Without governance, data quality improvements made for the implementation degrade within months of go-live.
- [ ] **Our ERP master data is synchronised with HR and other source systems**
  Mismatches between ERP and HRIS (employee records, cost centre assignments) are a major source of automation failures.

Process Maturity

- [ ] **The process we want to automate is fully documented end-to-end**
  You cannot automate a process you have not mapped. Undocumented exception handling is the most common source of post-go-live incidents.
- [ ] **We have defined and agreed approval hierarchies with no undocumented exceptions**
  Undocumented approval workarounds create gaps in automated workflows that require expensive custom configuration to resolve.
- [ ] **The process has a stable, predictable volume and is not subject to frequent structural changes**

Highly variable or frequently changing processes are poor automation candidates — the configuration overhead exceeds the efficiency gain.

- [ ] **We have a clear handover point between automated processing and human review**
The human-in-the-loop boundary must be explicitly designed — automation that eliminates all human review of financial transactions creates unacceptable control risk.

Technical Readiness

- [ ] **We know which ERP version we are running and have confirmed connector compatibility**
Connector compatibility is binary — an uncertified connector requires custom development that typically doubles implementation cost and timeline.

- [ ] **Our IT team has capacity to support the integration workstream**
Finance automation integrations require IT resource. Projects that start without confirmed IT allocation are delayed at the integration phase without exception.

- [ ] **We have an API or structured data export from our source systems**
Automation that relies on unstructured or manual data exports (copy-paste from ERP screens) has a fragile architecture that breaks with any system update.

- [ ] **We have a test environment available for UAT before go-live**
UAT in a production environment is not acceptable for financial systems. If no test environment exists, one must be created before vendor selection.

Skills and Capacity

- [ ] **Our finance team has experience working with automation or system implementation projects**
Teams with no system implementation experience consistently underestimate the time required for UAT, data migration, and change management.

- [ ] **We have a named project owner in finance with dedicated time allocation (minimum 30%)**
Finance automation projects without a dedicated internal owner fail more often than any other single risk factor.

- [ ] **We have a change management plan covering training, communication, and adoption measurement**
The most common cause of finance automation ROI failure is adoption failure — the team continues manual processes alongside the new system.

- [ ] **Our leadership team is aligned on the business case and prepared to support go-live decisions**
Leadership misalignment surfaces during UAT sign-off and go-live decisions. Resolve it before vendor selection, not after.

Governance and Controls

- [ ] **We have documented the control framework impact of removing manual processing steps**
Automation changes control risk — some manual controls are eliminated, some are strengthened, and new automated controls must be designed. This requires explicit analysis.

- [ ] **Our internal audit team is aware of the automation project and will be involved in sign-off**
Surprises for internal audit at year-end are avoidable. Early involvement ensures the audit trail design meets their requirements from the start.

- ☐ **We have confirmed the regulatory and compliance requirements for the processes in scope**
  VAT, per diem, data retention, and e-invoicing regulations vary by country. Non-compliance discovered after go-live is expensive to remediate.

- ☐ **We have a rollback plan if the automation fails to meet acceptance criteria at go-live**
  A documented rollback plan is not pessimism — it is evidence of mature project governance and is expected by internal audit and risk functions.

Scoring Your Readiness

Score	Readiness Level	Recommended Action
18–20	**Ready to proceed**	Move to vendor selection. Your foundation is strong.
13–17	**Proceed with caution**	Address identified gaps before go-live. Document your mitigation plan.
Below 13	**Not ready**	Invest 3–6 months in foundation work before starting automation.

Count one point for each item checked. A score below 13 does not mean automation is wrong — it means the foundation is not yet ready to support it reliably.

About This Resource

Developed by **Mirela Dragulescu**, a finance transformation specialist with 9+ years delivering finance automation readiness assessments and implementation programmes across European markets.

RELATED RESOURCES

The **Finance Automation Business Case Template** (premium, €39) provides the full ROI model and CFO sign-off framework once readiness is confirmed. The **Finance Automation ROI Calculator** (premium, €25) quantifies the financial case. Both available in the Resources section on MD Consulting's website.

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